SPACE CADET - a play on those choose-your-own-adventure books I kind of sort of remember from when I was younger

look up if google docs can do dynamic page links cause that'll make my life a lot easier

important: inject more TTRPG stuff into it!

- journaling!! this is the thing that'd make it unique
    - counterpoint: already made a solo journaling game
- stats/combat (books already had some of this iirc)
- inventory

should see if I can find a PDF of one of the ones I had for reference
after googling it seems no one else on planet earth had these books
NVM it was totally the Jackson/Livingstone ones but I can't find the space book specifically
"Fighting Fantasy" books

Deathtrap Dungeon:
https://files.spawningpool.net/docs/Tabletop%20Gamez/Vault%202.0/Vault2.0.-.Fiction-and-audiobooks/Books/Fighting%20Fantasy/FF06%20Deathtrap%20Dungeon.pdf
Starship Traveller:
https://files.spawningpool.net/docs/Tabletop%20Gamez/Vault%202.0/Vault2.0.-.Fiction-and-audiobooks/Books/Fighting%20Fantasy/Fighting%20Fantasy%2004%20Starship%20Traveller.pdf

like starship traveller (i.e. star trek) but more comedic (i.e. galaxy quest)

the point of the game books is CONVENIENCE so this should be similarly convenient
d6, pencil
scrap paper (but only for temporary things, not for character stuff)
cards maybe but even that might be "unreasonable"

stick to something similar to Starship Traveller for now (maybe a training sim) and then worry about depth if you flesh this out later

YOU PLAY AS _____, an intrepid young hero who just began their new job as a member of the Galactic Corps. Assigned to the diplomatic vessel Nautilus, you join Captain Wickersham's crew on their eternal voyage to bring peace to all worlds.

cool thing about Starship Traveller is you get to play as your entire crew at once - probably don't want to do that though

health/hit points separate from stats?
maybe stuck low
hit points are low but blaster shots have a high tendency to miss (wink wink star wars)?

stats:

diplomacy (charisma)
navigation (flying but also general movement stuff)
engineering (tech stuff)
weapons handling (combat)
psychic resistance (alien stuff?)

IDEA: include fill-in-the-blank stuff in the actual written part.
so like
Captain Wickersham turns to you. “The crew have decided to mutiny against me,” she says solemnly. You react with (emotion) _____.

this is so surface level but it’s also kind of fun and wacky

this is a LOT of writing to do in the next week

just proof out the essentials:

- “roleplay”
- dialogue
- combat

here’s an idea: make replaying PART of the story. you gain knowledge on one route that you can only use on the next route. time loop metroidvania sort of thing

route 1 ends - ALWAYS - with you falling into an alien warp drive or something
bad news: this won’t really work in written format. you’re going too video game-y. abort!
(this idea could potentially work if the format was different and less heavy on prose)